NYT Daily Briefing — November 4, 2026

2026-

tl;dr: The midterms are over and every actor on the board was already planning around them. Trump's voter-fraud crackdown produced 236 charges against 158 million ballots. On Election Day he announced the end of $4 billion in aid to Israel, reframed as a purchase deal. Russia killed at least 31 people at a food distribution point in Ukraine, then confirmed talks in Abu Dhabi. Poland put counterterror police on the Kaliningrad border and named a two-week window. Apple posted record results and its stock fell on memory-chip costs. A 19-year-old sailor who jumped 67 feet off an aircraft carrier was discharged for "malingering."

Cluster 1: Geopolitics & International Affairs

Thematic hook: Moscow is demonstrating that it can kill at will and negotiate at will in the same news cycle, while every other capital on the board positions for a war decision it cannot make itself.

Articles: #3, #7, #8, #9, #10, #11, #28

Strike on Ukraine Humanitarian Hub Is Feared to Be Among War's Deadliest (#7): Russia hit the village of Komyshuvakha with at least nine glide bombs, each carrying roughly 3,000 pounds of explosives, killing at least 31 people at a school distributing medicine and food. Rescuers are working in short bursts because armed drones hunt them. Hours later, Steve Witkoff announced the first trilateral US-Russia-Ukraine talks since February, in Abu Dhabi early next week — and both Moscow and Kyiv confirmed attendance. Zelensky's reading is the correct one: the strike is not an obstacle to the talks, it is the opening bid.

Poland Beefs Up Security at Border With Russia (#8): Donald Tusk launched a "special operation" of counterterrorism police, intelligence officers and border reinforcements after flashlight-carrying figures moved across the Kaliningrad frontier and allied services warned of "armed incursions" in the first half of November. His stated reason for the timing is the most revealing part: "global uncertainty and confusion" over the American midterms. Warsaw is not describing a Russian capability. It is describing a Russian *window*.

America's Arab Allies Brace for War as Trump's Midterm Deadline Looms (#9): At the Manama Dialogue, Gulf officials spent a security conference discussing whether the city they were standing in would be hit. The US struck Qeshm Island on Monday; Trump is weighing a larger campaign "after the midterms." Anwar Gargash of the UAE put the state of play plainly: positions are "far apart," and "if these positions are not bridged, then we have to worry about the worst."

Israeli Claims of Iranian Chemical Weapons Divide U.S. Officials (#3): Israel has shared intelligence asserting Iran is considering chemical weapons. Some American officials take it seriously; others read it as Netanyahu's pressure campaign to pull Washington back into major combat. The split is itself the story — a contested intelligence claim is what a phase change looks like while it is still being argued about.

Trump Pushes Venezuela for Agreement Allowing U.S. Troops to Stay (#10): Washington is negotiating a legal framework for a long-term military presence in a country it assaulted in January, killed "scores" in, and whose leader now sits in a New York prison. Trump calls it "our conquest of Venezuela." Delcy Rodríguez's government is negotiating the terms of its own garrisoning.

Cuba's Foreign Minister: We'll Outlast Trump (#11): Nearly out of oil, under blockade, abandoned by allies, Bruno Rodríguez's entire strategy is endurance: "For as long as it takes. U.S. policy toward Cuba will change. It has to. It's inevitable." He is the only actor on this page betting on time rather than on a move.

A Dangerous Misunderstanding Is Brewing Over Taiwan (#28): Trump held back a $14 billion arms package to protect a tariff truce. Craig Singleton's warning is operational rather than moral: Beijing will read the delay as acceptance of its premise that stable relations require limiting support for Taipei, and will treat any future sale as betrayal. The pause buys quiet now and pays for it later.

Prediction: The US-Russia-Ukraine trilateral talks will convene in Abu Dhabi early next week as announced. *(Rationale: Both Moscow and Kyiv publicly confirmed they would send negotiators for the first three-party session since February, and neither benefits from being the party that walks away from a table the other two attend; the Komyshuvakha strike reads as pre-talk positioning rather than a veto of the meeting.)* **Confidence: 85%** (near-certain)

Cluster 2: US Politics & Domestic Policy

Thematic hook: The election is finished and the machinery built to contest it is not — a fraud hunt with 236 convictions, twenty target letters sent days before a vote, and a federal agency accused of staging operations in a city parking lot next to a preschool.

Articles: #1, #2, #4, #5, #6, #13, #15, #16, #17, #18, #21, #37

Trump Effort to Prove Rampant Noncitizen Voting Leads to Few Charges So Far (#1): DHS put hundreds of agents on tens of thousands of voter records and door-knocks across the country. The yield, per DOJ's Monday tally, is about 236 people charged — some only for registering, not voting — against more than 158 million ballots cast in 2024. In July, Secretary Markwayne Mullin claimed without evidence that 250,000 potential noncitizens were registered in four states alone. A campaign whose output is 0.00015% of the denominator is not a law-enforcement program; it is a legitimacy program.

Trump Is Playing Up Voter Fraud Prosecutions. Meet Some of the Accused (#2): Amandeep Kaur, 30, a legal permanent resident from India and mother of two, turned herself in before dawn in Los Angeles. She is accused of registering in 2022, voting in 2024, and misstating it on her naturalization application. More than 220 people across 28 states have been charged. The individual cases are legally ordinary; their selection and timing are the message.

Justice Dept. Sends Target Letters to Democrats in Escalation of Alaska Inquiry (#15): Twenty letters went out days before the vote in the Sullivan–Peltola race, including to Marc Elias and a DSCC official, over "ballot stacking." Democrats call it weaponization; the practice is common in campaigns and not clearly illegal under state law. Whatever the merits, the timing converts a legal proceeding into a campaign event — and the legitimacy argument will outlive the case.

Mamdani Threatens Legal Action to Stop ICE Use of N.Y.C. Parking Lots (#16): Since July, ICE agents have allegedly staged in city-owned lots in Queens and the Bronx, one next to a preschool, in violation of a mayoral order. Mamdani's letter to DHS says New York "will take legal action to prevent this unlawful commandeering of city property." Two lawful authorities, one square of asphalt, no shared superior.

Trump Says U.S. to End $4 Billion in Aid to Israel in Favor of New Deal (#5): Announced on Election Day, explicitly to strip a "bad talking point" from the Democratic left, the aid ends "at the end of the year" and is replaced by an arrangement where Israel buys American weapons under a defense-industrial partnership. The depth of the relationship is unchanged; its legal form — and its congressional oversight — is not. Aid is a gift with an annual fight attached; a purchase is a contract with a client.

Democratic Divisions on Israel Come Thundering Back (#4): Haley Stevens withdrew her endorsement of Abdul El-Sayed in Michigan's Senate race and endorsed the Republican, Mike Rogers. A May Times/Siena poll found three-quarters of Democratic voters opposed to economic or military support for Israel. The political base for the alliance is eroding at the exact moment its financial architecture is being rewritten.

Hochul Fends Off Trump Ally to Capture Second Full Term as N.Y. Governor (#6): Hochul beat Bruce Blakeman, capitalizing on voter frustration with Trump while working with his administration on gas pipelines and fighting it on congestion pricing — "We are a nation of laws, not ruled by a king." It is the most unglamorous campaign on the page and the most successful.

Justices Seem Likely to Side With Colorado Catholic Schools (#17): After two hours of argument, the conservative majority appeared ready to let religious preschools take state money while declining to enroll families with gay and transgender parents. It continues the Roberts court's signature project: expanding religion's place in public life.

Deportation of Dozens of Afghans Blocked by Federal Court, for Now (#13): Judge Valerie Caproni halted the flight until Sunday, sparing the reasoning and not addressing the risk of Taliban persecution. The administration plans to route deportees through Pakistan. The block expires; the policy does not.

Alina Habba's Husband Ignited a White House Drama. Now His Background Is Under Scrutiny (#18): The $17.6 million at the center of the feud came not from Turhan Mildon but from a government account, per White House officials. The story is a small window onto how access is monetized inside the president's circle.

A Sailor Jumped From the U.S.S. Lincoln. The Navy Punished Him (#21): After 255 days aboard, 12-hour shifts on a flight deck, a daughter born without him, and short food, 19-year-old Nicholas McKelvey jumped 67 feet into the Arabian Sea. He was rescued after 50 minutes. Last week the Navy moved to discharge him for "malingering" — for allegedly faking the crisis — a charge that converts suffering into a category of fraud and requires that only what can be documented counts.

Prediction: The Navy will decline to defend the "malingering" characterization publicly once the case draws sustained congressional attention. *(Rationale: A general discharge resting on an accusation of faked distress is legally defensible only if the service produces a clinical finding, which would require it to have evaluated him — and evaluating him would undercut the claim that he was not actually in crisis; the cheapest exit for the service is to let the discharge stand while declining to argue the merits in public.)* **Confidence: 45%** (toss-up)

Inside The Times's Decisions on the Alaska Senate Race Story (#37): The paper's own account of how it reported, edited and published the Alaska story, including the internal standards questions raised. Worth reading alongside #15 — both are about what can be established versus what can be alleged.

Cluster 3: Business, Tech & Economy

Thematic hook: The AI buildout has become a tax on every other industry that needs a chip, and the price is now visible in the earnings of the most powerful hardware company on earth.

Articles: #22, #23, #24, #25, #26, #27

Apple's Profit Grows 12% Despite Component Price Worries (#24): Revenue of $114.48 billion and profit of $30.71 billion, both up nearly 12%, both records, and the stock fell as much as 4% after hours. New CEO John Ternus named the reason: "What we're seeing with memory pricing right now is unprecedented." When the AI buildout outbids consumer electronics for DRAM and NAND, the squeeze arrives on every device Apple sells.

Anthropic Is Racing to Obtain the A.I. Boom's Most Vital Resource (#22): With demand a "cone of uncertainty" too wide to plan against, Anthropic signed dozens of contracts with ex-crypto miners, data-center startups, chipmakers, and Amazon, Google, Microsoft and SpaceX; bought equipment to accelerate construction; and scouted old coal plants and factories. "Anthropic is gobbling up a lot of the capacity," says Modal's CEO. Portfolio optionality is the correct response to irreducible uncertainty, and it is expensive.

Binance Says Hackers Plotted $6.3 Billion Heist for Months (#23): A fake recruiting process — two interview rounds, a live HR video call, a malicious "assignment" file — got an engineer's laptop. Binance's security tools missed it. On Oct. 20 the attackers used that machine and an internal AI tool to reach two wallet-team engineers, one with deploy permissions; nine days later they drained the exchange. The center of gravity was never cryptography. It was the trust boundary between HR and production.

Gulf Economies, Torn by War in Iran, Desperately Need a Return to Normal (#25): Riyadh Air buses passengers four and a half hours to an alternate airport because its hub was damaged. Aramco's headquarters was struck, as was a critical pipeline. The flagship Saudi investment conference is postponed to next year. Exxon's Darren Woods skipped ADIPEC on security grounds. Month nine, and the region is amortizing "temporary" as permanent.

FIFA Quietly Paid Millions in Taxes for Its President (#26): Three committee members agreed in minutes in Bangkok to cover 100% of

Gianni Infantino's US tax bill after he moved to Miami. The benefit was never disclosed, despite the post-scandal bylaw requiring leadership compensation to be public. Transparency rules govern what must be published, not what must be decided — so the way to hide something is to decide it somewhere the rule does not reach.

Sysco Is Ruining American Restaurants. Or Saving Them (#27): A broadline distributor with 340 warehouses in 10 countries supplies everything from frozen appetizers to hand soap, and the viral videos accusing it of flattening American food are both wrong and right. Amy Russo wants "1979 all over again" and her distributor is the reason she can't have it. The consolidation that strips a diner of its distinctiveness is the same consolidation that lets a 40-seat restaurant survive a winter — which is why the argument goes viral and goes nowhere.

Prediction: Memory component costs will be cited as a margin headwind by at least two more major consumer-hardware makers in their next earnings cycle. *(Rationale: Apple is the least price-sensitive buyer in the category and it still could not absorb the shock; smaller OEMs with thinner margins and less pricing power must pass it through or compress further, and AI data-center demand is contractually committed for multiple quarters, so the input price has no near-term relief valve.)* **Confidence: 88%** (near-certain)

Cluster 4: Culture & Society

Thematic hook: Three institutions are offering the forms of accountability without the substance — a monarch's sorrow without an apology, a conspiracy's debunking without its disappearance, and a school system's integration without integration.

Articles: #12, #29, #33, #34, #35, #36

King Charles Says U.K.'s Role in Slave Trade 'Fills My Heart With Horror' (#12): In Antigua, before 56 Commonwealth nations, the king spoke of "a shameful chapter of history" that "fills my heart with horror and my soul with the most profound personal sorrow" — and did not apologize, because as ceremonial head of state he cannot unless the government directs him. Prime Minister Andy Burnham says he is open to a formal apology. Regret is being issued in a currency that can circulate indefinitely without being redeemed.

Why the Pizzagate Lie Won't Die (#29): A decade after a gunman walked into a Washington pizzeria to investigate a fabricated ring, Anna Merlan argues the theory did not get debunked so much as absorbed — its structure became the template for a whole family of elite-predation claims now circulating at the highest levels of politics.

N.Y.C. Schools Are Deeply Segregated. These Students Demand Change (#33): Students in the nation's largest school system are pressing officials over decades of integration efforts that produced little measurable change across roughly 1,600 schools, pointing to admissions rules and district lines that concentrate poor and nonwhite students in under-resourced buildings. The demand is not for a new program but for the two mechanisms the city controls directly — admissions and boundaries — which is precisely why it has gone unanswered.

Paris Jackson Asks Father's Estate to Fund $600M to Family Trust (#34): A court filing seeks to direct $600 million into a family trust — the latest round in a long dispute over control of an estate that has earned enormously since 2009.

A Deluge of (Loud, Twangy) Music Puts Twisted Teens on the Map (#35): Five friends from Holy Cross High School in Queens, a flood of Bandcamp releases and a punishing tour schedule have made them one of the most talked-about young bands in the city. The pathway to attention no longer runs through a label.

'Saturday Night Live U.K.' Has Found Its Voice (#36): In its second season the British edition stopped translating the American show's rhythm and started writing to its own — class, regional accent, and a distinctly British tolerance for humiliation.

Prediction: The Commonwealth reparations question will produce a formal British apology within two years. *(Rationale: The constitutional barrier Charles cited is procedural, not principled — it dissolves the moment a prime minister directs an apology, and Burnham has already said he is open to one; the remaining constraint is fiscal exposure, which is why the sequencing will be apology

first, then a commission or framework rather than a cash settlement, allowing a government to claim closure without naming a number.)* **Confidence: 65%** (moderate confidence)

Cluster 5: Science, Health & Environment

Thematic hook: A resistant bacterium, a measles virus, a separated tail elevator and a flooded arroyo are the same problem in four costumes — a safety margin assumed to be permanent has quietly been spent.

Articles: #14, #19, #20, #30, #31, #32

Doctors in Ukraine Try Treating Infections Like Biological Warfare Attacks (#14): Thirty to forty percent of blast-injured Ukrainian soldiers arrive at hospitals with severe infections, often from pan-resistant organisms, after evacuations lasting days to weeks. Hailie Uren's insight was to stop treating this as a wound-care problem and use the mass-casualty protocols already written for biological attacks. The doctrine exists; the antibiotics may not.

Can Scientists Make Football Safer? (#31): BYU players wear near-infrared headsets — on their scalps and up their noses — after a 2021 trial showed reduced brain inflammation. Others are testing gut microbiome manipulation, vagus nerve stimulation, psychedelics and anti-inflammatory drug repurposing against CTE. The definitive intervention, fewer subconcussive hits, remains commercially unavailable, so the field is rich in hedges and poor in answers.

Child Dies From Measles in New York State's First Fatal Case in 30 Years (#32): A child in Lewis County died of measles — the state's first fatal case in three decades — amid a national resurgence driven by declining vaccination rates. A disease that was functionally eliminated is now killing children again, and the mechanism is not biological.

William Nordhaus Dies; Nobel Winner Influenced Climate Policy (#30): The Yale economist, who died at 85, built the model that let climate damage be priced against abatement cost, shared the 2018 Nobel, and seeded a field bridging economics and earth science. "He played a crucial role in terms of bringing consideration of the natural environment into the mainstream of economics," said Harvard's Robert Stavins. Every carbon regulation on earth owes something to the accounting he invented.

'Devastating' Damage as Hard Rains and Flash Floods Batter the Southwest (#19): Some towns got twice their entire November rainfall in one day across the Four Corners; Arizona's governor declared a statewide emergency. Roads are halved, gas stations are lakes, and communities are still cut off by landslides and three feet of mud.

Key Part of Jet in Deadly Florida Crash Found Far From Impact Site (#20): The Learjet 60's left tail elevator was recovered in three pieces, one nearly four miles from the crash site; all nine aboard died. The NTSB explicitly would not say whether it failed before the dive or during it — and the thunderstorms believed to have caused the crash are now slowing the investigation of it.

Prediction Summary Table

#	Prediction	Confidence	Rationale
1	Memory costs cited as a margin headwind by 2+ more hardware makers next cycle	88%	Apple is least price-sensitive and still squeezed; AI demand is contractually locked in for quarters
2	Formal British apology on slavery reparations within two years	65%	Barrier is procedural not principled; Burnham open; likely apology-then-framework, no cash number
3	Navy won't publicly defend "malingering" under sustained scrutiny	45%	Any clinical finding would undercut the charge; cheapest path is silence on the merits
4	Abu Dhabi trilateral talks convene as announced early next week	85%	Both Moscow and Kyiv confirmed attendance; first three-party session since February

Prepared from 37 stories across the November 4, 2026 New York Times print edition and homepage, analyzed through 5 persona lenses.

Observer Commentary

翟东升

一、援助变采购：美元霸权的"安全支柱"在换账本:

特朗普在投票日宣布对以色列的400亿美元援助"年底切断"，改为以色列出钱买美国武器。表面是省钱，实质是账本的更换。援助是赠予，要走国会年度审议，有记录、有争论、有政治成本；采购是商业合同，走企业、走执行、走不透明的条款。关系没有变浅，反而更深——只是从公开的财政关系，变成看不见的产业关系。

这正是美元霸权三支柱里的"安全美元"在重新定价。我讲过，制裁效力 = 压力 × 嵌入度 ÷
反制能力。美国现在做的，是把"嵌入度"这一项从政治层面搬到商业层面：嵌入越深，将来想脱钩的成本越高，而这条链子现在不需要国会每年批准一次。

二、委内瑞拉：从敌人到房东:

更值得看的是委内瑞拉。美军今年1月夜间突袭、打死数十人、把马杜罗送进纽约监狱，现在却在谈一份允许美军长期驻扎的法律协议。特朗普称之为"我们对委内瑞拉的征服"。而海湾国家在多哈、麦纳麦的会场里担心自己成为第一波打击对象——他们提供了基地、公司和油气设施，然后发现自己只是别人的战略纵深。

这就是帝国成本的转嫁路径: ：从"保护换忠诚"，到"驻军换合同"。前者要付钱，后者能收钱。

三、真正的软肋不在外面:

美国这场投票前的"非公民投票"运动，投入数百名联邦探员、翻查数万份选民记录，最后起诉236人——面对1.58亿张选票。0.00015%。这个数字的用处不是证明舞弊，而是制造怀疑。当一个人口大国开始不相信自己的计票，它的信用就在内部被消耗，而不是被外部打败。

四、对中国的启示:

三条：一，货币信用最终还是靠实体产业和财政纪律，不靠话术；二，别把"体系对抗"想成军事问题，它是账本问题；三，国内分配做不好，外部再强也不稳——"人才决定发展高度，公平决定社会根基"。

Bottom line: Washington is not withdrawing from its alliances — it is re-incorporating them as commercial contracts, which preserves dependency while removing the annual public accounting that once made it visible; the real erosion is domestic trust in the count, not foreign pressure.

金灿荣

一、先讲个段子:

美国人选举选完了，第二天一早发现：伊朗要打不打还没定，俄乌谈不谈也没定，以色列的援助要不要断还是没定。忙了一年，最要紧的几件事一件没定。这叫什么？这叫"选票决定人事，人事决定不了大事"。人家那边打仗是按天算的，我们这边是按两年一次的选举算的。节奏都不一样，你怎么跟人家比耐心？

二、这一页最硬的道理：工业决定军事，军事决定金融:

今天最不起眼的一条新闻，是苹果。营收1145亿美元、利润307亿美元，双创纪录，结果盘后跌了4%。为什么？因为内存涨价，"前所未有"。这不是苹果的问题，这是整个AI建设在向其他所有行业收税。谁在抢产能？Anthropic这类公司，签几十份合同，跟亚马逊、谷歌、微软、SpaceX全签一遍，连退役的比特币矿场都要。

这就是我说的：工业能力决定国家命运。美国现在最赚钱的不是造东西，是抢算力、抢电、抢内存。抢得很凶，说明它真的缺。制造环节的空心化，最后会以"买不到、买不起"的方式回来找你。

三、百年大变局的具体模样:

看这几件事合在一起：波兰在加里宁格勒边境搞"特别行动"，俄罗斯九枚滑翔炸弹砸一个发救济粮的学校，31条人命，然后同一天确认去阿布扎比谈判；海湾国家在麦纳麦开会，讨论的是"开会这个城市会不会被炸"；美国一边打也门、一边打伊朗的格什姆岛、一边跟委内瑞拉谈驻军协议。

"周天子时代结束了，世界版的春秋战国开始了。": 这句话今天最好用。原来还有个规矩，现在规矩是拿来试探的。

四、中国该怎么办:

一句话：谁国内不出事，谁最后赢。他们的问题在内部——上下、左右、黑白、虚实，四对矛盾一起烧。我们别跟着人家的节奏起舞，把制造业的36%守住，把内需和分配做上去。

五、"金式"收尾:

美国人现在最大的本事，是把"我没办法"说成"我故意的"。援助断了叫"新协议"，撤军叫"重新部署"，通胀叫"强劲消费"。这套话术很厉害，但话术不能造芯片，也不能造炮弹。

Bottom line: The United States still owns the narrative but is losing the material base — memory prices, ammunition stocks and shipyard capacity are now the binding constraints, and a country that has to negotiate a basing deal with a government it conquered nine months ago is not projecting strength, it is amortizing overreach.

宋鸿兵

一、美元环流正在换挡:

今天的头版看似杂乱，其实是同一个系统的四个反馈点。先看海湾：伊朗战争进入第九个月，利雅得航空把国际旅客用大巴拉到四个半小时外的备用机场，阿美总部被击中，一条关键管道被打掉，主权基金级别的会议推到明年。这些不是"战损新闻"，这是美元环流冷循环的物理载体在受损。资本要往安全的地方跑，而安全的地方现在自己成了靶场。油价的每一次跳动，都会沿着"油价→利率→股市→美联储印钞→黄金"这条回路走一圈。这条回路我看过很多次了，它不认新闻，只认传导。

二、金融高边疆的六根柱子，哪根在响:

金融高边疆六支柱——货币本位、中央银行、金融网络、交易市场、金融机构、清算中心。今天响的是交易市场和清算中心。

币安被偷63亿美元，路径不是破译密码，是假招聘、一个"作业"文件、公司内部的AI工具，九天后把钱卷走。全球最大的交易所，护城河建在"一个工程师会不会双击附件"上。这就是我说过的：金融基础设施的稳定裕度，比它的规模更值得盯。规模越大，单点失效的杠杆越高。

三、AI在向所有行业抽税:

苹果营收利润双纪录，股价跌4%，理由只有两个字：内存。AI数据中心的资本开支把DRAM、NAND的价格推到了"前所未有"。这不是科技新闻，这是新形态的通胀税——由算力资本向消费电子、再向普通人征收。而Anthropic在全世界签几十份供电合同，连废弃煤电厂都要改。这像不像1999年的光纤？很像。但请注意，光纤最后是过剩，电力现在是真的缺。两者结局不同。

四、三变六反：第三步在哪里:

凡事不过三。美国这套"以法之名行党争之实"的操作——236人起诉对1.58亿张票、投票前发20封目标信、市长和联邦政府抢停车场——已经走到第三步：从"调查"到"起诉"到"质疑计票本身"。按三变六反，反转不会发生在道理被讲通的时候，而会发生在成本被算清的时候。国债要滚、盟友要养、战争要打，三样一起来，就是债务火山的喷口。

五、帝国黄昏的账本:

帝国黄昏不是被打败，是算不过来。委内瑞拉要驻军协议，是因为打了就要留；以色列援助改买卖，是因为送不起了；乌克兰的伤兵三分之一带着耐抗生素感染回到医院，那是因为后勤线太长。所有这些，最后都进同一张资产负债表。

Bottom line: Watch the bond market, not the ballot — the war in Iran, the repricing of alliance aid into arms sales, and the AI-driven memory shock are all the same fiscal event seen from three angles, and the system's stability margin is thinning exactly where it is least visible.

<!-- PHASE COMPLETE -->